

Spas Zahariev

SOFTWARE ENGINEER LEAD

Zurich, Switzerland

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Summary

Software Engineering Lead with 7+ years across fintech and large-scale consulting, specialising in backend systems (Java, Python) and cloud delivery (Azure, AWS). Experienced in leading and mentoring engineering teams while owning architecture from design through production. Extends beyond backend with hands-on full-stack and AI/ML work, with a strong focus on clean architecture and pragmatic CI/CD practices.

Work Experience

EPAM Systems

Zurich, Switzerland

SOFTWARE ENGINEER LEAD (PROMOTED FROM SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER)

Oct. 2021 - Present

- Saved an average of 2 hours of prep-work per meeting for investment committee members by building an AI Agent that uses RAG to quickly navigate documents prior to a pitch meeting.
- Automated data lineage reconciliation and eliminated key-person risks from a bank's regulatory reporting pipeline. Scaled the system to reconcile 500K+ entities/day across 12 source databases within a year by designing and leading a 7-engineer team to build a cloud-based ingestion and transformation workflow in Java and Python.
- Strengthened hiring/promotion rigor through ongoing expert-assessment committee and interview panel service, mentoring engineers and evaluating candidates.

JPMorgan Chase

London, United Kingdom

SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Sep. 2019 - Oct. 2021

- Streamlined liquidity monitoring for 10+ analysts, replacing manual reporting with live dashboards, by building WebSocket-driven React/Redux dashboard + automated Excel reporting.
- Cut messaging latency 85% (30min to <5min) turnaround for 150K+ msgs/hr by redesigning a Java service with Kafka + async processing.

JPMorgan Chase

Bournemouth, United Kingdom

SOFTWARE ENGINEER SUMMER INTERN

Jun. 2018 - Sep. 2018

- Gave QA visibility into thousands of tests, centralizing tracking into one searchable Test Management Dashboard (Spring Boot + Angular).
- Automated meeting-minutes transcription across 3 departments by building a Python speech-to-text application, which won first place among 40 teams at an internal hackathon before being extended into production.

Education

University of Southampton

Southampton, United Kingdom

BENG IN SOFTWARE ENGINEERING (FIRST CLASS HONOURS)

Sep. 2016 - Jun. 2019

Sofia High School of Mathematics

Sofia, Bulgaria

SECONDARY EDUCATION DIPLOMA (5.91 / 6.00, A*)

Sep. 2011 - May 2016

Skills

Languages

Java, Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Go, Kotlin, Dart, SQL, C#, C++, Rust, Bash, Lua, Haskell

Frameworks & Services

Spring Boot, React, Angular, Node.js, Tailwindcss, Dioxus, Flutter, Flask, Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, gRPC, Protobuf, GraphQL, REST, WebSockets, Neo4j, AWS, Google Cloud (Vertex AI, BigQuery, Cloud Functions), Microsoft Azure, Azure Purview, PostgreSQL, IBM DB2, Kafka, Spark, Beam, S3, Jenkins CI/CD, TensorFlow/Keras, Machine learning, deep learning, LLMs, RAG

Soft Skills & Practices

MLOps, microservices, event-driven architecture, DDD, clean code, mentoring, Agile, Scrum

Certificates

Apr. 2026 **Claude Code Architect**, Anthropic

Mar. 2026 **Google Professional ML Engineer**, Google Cloud

May. 2023 **Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD)**, The Linux Foundation

Apr. 2023 **Microsoft Azure Developer Associate (AZ-204)**, Microsoft

Apr. 2020 **Oracle Cloud Architect**, Oracle

Feb. 2016 **Unity GameDev Course**, SoftUni